have been lost due to menstruation. There is a marginal increase in the iron intake.

### Vitamins

The additional need of vitamin A during lactation is based on the amount secreted in the mother's milk. As the calorie and protein requirements increase during lactation, the requirements of B vitamins also increase correspondingly. Ascorbic acid content increases during lactation.

### Galactogogues

Galactogogues are foods that help to produce more milk. Garlic, milk and almonds are considered to increase milk production. Studies carried out on nursing mothers have revealed that extra amounts of body building foods like fish and mutton increase the secretion of breast milk. Lactating mothers are also given special preparations containing ajwain and fenugreek seeds, which supply iron, protein, calcium and B- complex vitamins.

CASE STUDY

**Case study 2**

Jeni is pregnant. She comes for nutrition counselling. Explain to her the six nutrients that are required in larger amounts during pregnancy Describe their special roles and suggest four food sources for each.

## 6.8 NUTRITIONAL NEEDS AND CHALLENGES DURING OLD AGE

Individuals above the age of 60 years constitute the elderly. Health and well-being of the elderly is given more importance and has paved way for a specific field of study called "Geriatric Nutrition".

### Aging

Aging is an irreversible biochemical change that occurs throughout an individual's life cycle and continues until death. In old age, the nutritional status is determined by the state of nutrition of an individual's cell. Conditions like dietary deficiency,

**Table 14** A Balanced Vegetarian Diet For Pregnant and Lactating Mother Doing Sedentary Work

| S.No | Food group | Pregnant mother Quantity (g) | Lactating mother Quantity (g) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | Cereals millets | 300 | 330 |
| 2 | Pulses | 60 | 90 |
| 3 | Milk(ml) | 500 | 500 |
| 4 | Roots and tubers | 100 | 100 |
| 5 | Green leafy vegetable | 150 | 150 |
| 6 | Other vegetable | 100 | 100 |
| 7 | Fruit | 200 | 200 |
| 8 | Sugar | 20 | 20 |
| 9 | Fats and oil(visible) | 30 | 30 |

Source: Dietary Guidelines for Indians - A manual, NationalInstitute of Nutrition, ICMR, Hyderabad, India, (1999)



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